Community Water Quality Monitoring Procedure

Revision 2 proposed candidate. Technical-editor and client approval required.

Purpose: This procedure explains how field teams collect and record drinking water samples to ensure reliable results traceable to the correct site.

Scope: Applies to routine samples from reservoirs, treatment outlets, and public taps. Does not cover emergency chemical spills or laboratory instrument calibration.

Responsibilities: Team leader verifies each technician's PPE, clean sample bottles, and calibrated meter. Technicians are responsible for completing QMS-07's Chain of Custody Form and reporting unsafe conditions.

Procedure: Before sampling, allow the tap to run for 2 minutes. Rinse the probe with clean water. Do not rinse a sterile microbiological bottle. Record pH and turbidity in NTU at the site. Samples must be kept in a cooler between 2 and 8 degrees Celsius.

Data recording: Document site code, date, time, and sampler initials on both the bottle and QMS-07. Corrections must be made with a single line through the error; correction fluids are not permitted. State the reason for any missing reading.

Escalation: If pH is below 6.5 or above 9.5, or turbidity is higher than 1 NTU, notify the team leader immediately. Do not tell the community that the water is safe or unsafe until the authorised official has reviewed the result.